Agile Team Charter

1. Team Purpose & Vision

Why do we exist as a team?

Team mission:
What problem are we solving? For whom?

We aim to solve the problem of limited access to affordable, convenient, and nutritious food among CPUT students, who often struggle with tight budgets, busy schedules, and unhealthy eating habits.SmartStudent Pantry provides budget-friendly pantry packs and study snacks that save time, reduce stress, and help students maintain better energy and focus for their academic success.

Success definition:
How will we know we are successful?

- Reaching and consistently serving 20–30 active CPUT students
- Receiving repeat orders from students (customer retention)
- Positive feedback on affordability, convenience, and quality
- Ability to deliver orders on time without issues
- Generating enough revenue to sustain and restock the pantry

Product / Service:
What are we responsible for delivering?

- Affordable pantry bundles (basic groceries like rice, pasta, canned foods)
- Study snack packs (quick, ready-to-eat items for studying)
- Simple meal kits with easy preparation
- A reliable ordering system (manual or web-based)
- Timely delivery or pickup service for CPUT students

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2. Team Members & Roles

Who is on the team and how do we contribute?

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Collins Shibambo	Product Owner	- Defines the overall vision of SmartStudent Pantry - Identifies student needs and ensures the product solves real problems - Decides what features should be built - Communicates with stakeholders (lecturer, users, team)
Elona Sonjica	Agile Lead	- Manages the Agile process and ensures the team follows Scrum practices - Organizes meetings (stand-ups, sprint planning, reviews) - Removes obstacles blocking team progress - Keeps the team focused and productive - Tracks progress and ensures deadlines are met
Avuyile Twesha	Developer / Analyst	- Designs and develops the system (e.g., Spring Boot backend, frontend features) - Analyses system requirements and translates them into technical solutions - Builds core features like ordering system, user accounts, and inventory tracking - Tests functionality during development - Collaborates with designer and tester for improvements
Inga Plati	Designer / Tester	- Designs user interface (UI) and user experience (UX) - Creates wireframes and layout of the system - Ensures the system is user-friendly and visually clear - Tests the system for bugs and errors - Provides feedback on usability and suggests improvements

3. Ways of Working

How we work together day to day

3.1 Agile Framework

- Kanban

We will use the Kanban framework to manage tasks and workflow. Work items will be visualised on a Kanban board with columns such as:

- To Do
- In Progress
- Testing
- Done

This allows the team to track progress in real time, limit work-in-progress, and quickly identify bottlenecks.

3.2 Ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency	Purpose
Daily Stand-up	Every day (10–15 min)	Team members briefly share what they worked on, what they will do next, and any blockers. Keeps everyone aligned.
Planning	Twice per week	Decide which tasks will be worked on next, assign responsibilities, and update the Kanban board.
Review / Demo	End of each week	Demonstrate complete features (e.g., ordering system, UI) and gather feedback from team members or stakeholders.
Retrospective	End of each week	Reflect on what went well, what didn't, and how the team can improve in the next cycle.

4. Working Agreements

Rules we agree to follow as a team

- We show up prepared and on time
- We respect timeboxes
- We give constructive feedback
- We raise blockers early
- We commit to continuous improvement
- All members must attend scheduled meetings (stand-ups, sprint planning, reviews).
- Being more than 5 minutes late without notice is unacceptable.
- Missing a meeting requires valid communication beforehand.
- All tasks must be completed on or before the agreed deadline.
- No last-minute work submissions unless approved by the Agile Lead.
- Failure to deliver work must be reported at least 24 hours in advance.
- Each member is responsible for their assigned tasks, no excuses for incomplete work.
- Any problem blocking progress must be raised immediately, not at the deadline.
- No disrespectful behaviour, this includes ignoring team members.
- After each sprint, the team must identify at least one improvement action.

Add or remove agreements as needed.

5. Communication

How and when we communicate

- **Primary channels:** Teams, WhatsApp
- **Response-time expectations:** core hours (weekdays 9:00 – 17:00). Messages should be responded within 2 to 3 hours.
- **Remote / hybrid norms:** Team communication mainly happen via WhatsApp and Teams, members must be available unless stated otherwise, join meeting on time, camera is optional and stay available.

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6. Decision-Making

How decisions are made

- ☐ Consensus
- ☐ Team vote

The team will aim to make decisions through consensus, where all members contribute ideas and agree on the best solution. This encourages collaboration and ensures everyone is aligned.

If a consensus cannot be reached, the team will use a team voting approach to make decisions. Each member will have an equal say, and decisions will be made based on the majority vote. This ensures fairness and encourages active participation from all team members.

- *Escalation path if we're stuck:*

If the team is unable to resolve an issue, we will ask for guidance from the lecturer by doing a consultation

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7. Definition of Done (DoD)

When is work really "done"?

- The task is fully completed according to requirements.
- Code has been completed, reviewed and tested.
- Pantry packs or services are prepared correctly.
- Content is clear, correct, properly formatted and reviewed.
- The team or Product Owner/lecturer confirms the work meets expectations.

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8. Core Values & Behaviours

How we treat each other

- Respect
- Transparency
- Accountability
- Trust
- Learning mindset
- Adaptability
- Commitment
- Collaboration

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9. Risks & Constraints

What could impact our success?

Known risks:

- Low student adoption – students may not be interested in buying pantry packs
- Pricing issues – products may be too expensive for student budgets
- Stock shortages – running out of essential items (rice, canned food, etc.)
- Delivery delays – late or missed deliveries to residences/campus
- Poor team coordination – miscommunication or missed deadlines
- Technical failures – system bugs or downtime during ordering
- Scope creep – adding too many features beyond initial plan
- Time mismanagement – falling behind sprint deadlines
- Data loss – losing order or customer information
- Quality issues – incorrect or damaged items in packs

Dependencies:

- Suppliers – availability and pricing of food items
- Team member availability – each member completing their assigned work
- Internet access – required for system development and communication
- Tools & platforms – GitHub, development environment, communication apps
- User feedback – needed to validate product and improve system
- Delivery logistics – access to transport or reliable delivery method

Constraints (time, budget, tools, skills):

Time Constraints

- Limited time due to academic schedule and deadlines
- Short sprint cycles for development and testing

Budget Constraints

- Limited funds for purchasing stock and packaging
- No advanced paid tools or systems

Tools & Technology Constraints

- Limited access to advanced development tools
- Possible lack of experience with frameworks (e.g., Spring Boot)
- System must be simple due to time and skill level

Skills Constraints

- Team members may lack experience in certain areas (backend, UI design, testing)
- Learning new technologies while developing the project
- Operational Constraints
- Limited delivery capacity (manual delivery only)
- Small initial customer base

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10. Review & Improvement

Keeping the charter alive

- Charter reviewed every:
  ☐ Quarter ☐ Release ☐ ✓ Retrospective
- Last updated: 03 May 2026

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11. Team Commitment

Our agreement to this charter

By working on this team, we commit to the principles and agreements outlined above.

Name	**Signature/Agreement**
Collins Shibambo	C.Shibambo
Avuyile Twesha	A.Twesha
Inga Plati	I.P
Elona Sonjica	E.Sonjica